Chapter 22

O sinivi suuna – The indigenous canoe

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Figure 1: *Sinivi suuna* – Indigenous canoe

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(1)	*O sinivi suuna*	The indigenous canoe
(2)	*O matapaku no sinivi suuna na kao vonaen:*	The method of making an indigenous canoe is as follows:
(3)	*Eara na hopo rara rasuu to tei nana o naono,*	We go into the jungle where the tree is,
(4)	*eara repaa sisira o naono havee toro busu voe beara tagava e.*	then we examine where the tree should fall down when we fell it.
(5)	*Eara repaa hanakahi vamataa nie.*	We clean the undergrowth completely for it.
(6)	*Be kuu gunaha, eara repaa ipinoo e, ei teo manin tea otei vai to pasi paku nana bono sinivi.*	When (the tree) has fallen down, we measure it according to the wish of the man who will make the canoe.
(7)	*O ipinoo he na paku raara bona bebeahu na kuriraara, evehe ei kou ei, eara toro siisira vamataa o naono,*	The measurement we take with the length of our arm, while at the same time we must thoroughly examine the tree,
(8)	*eara mene mosi vahoara o hum vai o vageegeno ge to tanove nana.*	so that we won't accidentally cut a crooked part or (a part) that is bulky.
(9)	*Be kavara o hum kiu bona, eara repaa vaobete vamataa e.*	When this part of work is finished, we lay it down properly.

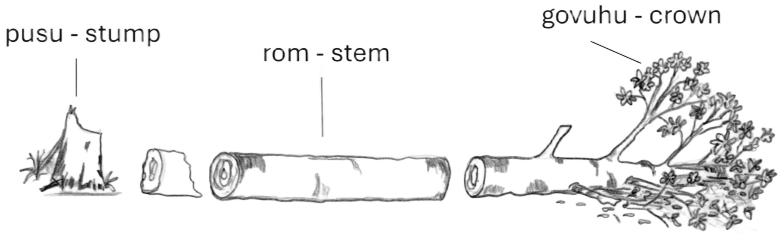


Figure 2: *O naono tagava* – The felled tree

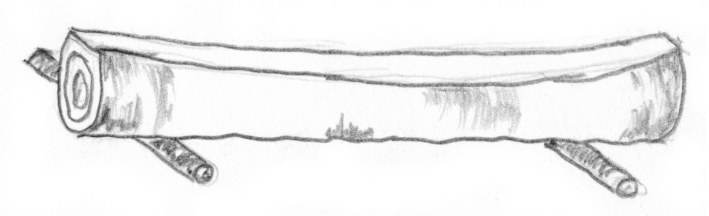


Figure 3: *Poana* – Slice the upper part off

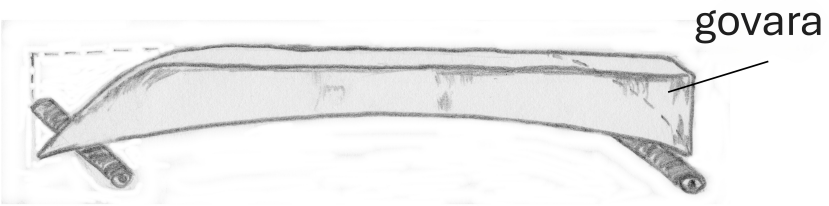


Figure 4: *Paku a bua govara* – Make the two pointed ends

(10)	*Murinae eara repaa poana mae,*	After that we slice its upper part off,
(11)	*eara repaa paku pete a kiu vaa tea papaesi.*	then we do the next work of cutting the sides into shape.
(12)	*Beara papaes vakavara, eara repaa vahio vamataa vahabana e,*	When we have finished cutting the sides, we place it properly again,
(13)	*eara repaa taneo tea kepo.*	then we start carving.
(14)	*Kepo, are kepo, beara kepo ae mosi gunagunaha vaantee bata maara o ipinoo ge o manin tea too vaahito no sinivi.*	Carve, then we carve, while we are carving and cutting downwards according to the measurement or the wish of the owner of the canoe.

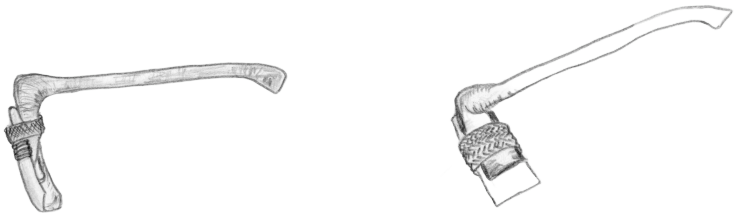
(15)	*Murina maa taba vaarii eara repaa vaakopo e.*	After these things, we turn it upside down.
(16)	*Eara repaa paku mana maa a bua govara vaa matana ae vaa itao.*	Then we eventually make the two pointed ends at the bow and at the stern.
(17)	*Beara paku vakavara a bua govara, o sinivi kou tavusu vai ei.*	When we have done the two pointed ends, the canoe is taking shape now.
(18)	*Be kavara, eara repaa paku pete a mosi na taeno sinivi, o hum to kahi hiohio ni nae o sinivi.*	When (this is) finished, we do the cutting of the bottom of the canoe (from the outside), the part on which the canoe will sit.
(19)	*Murina mosi bona, eara repaa paku pete a meha papaesi.*	After this cut, we do another cut along the sides of the canoe.
(20)	*A papaesi bona to kahi sue bata ka nom araara havee toro mosi kaakoo ara.*	This cut along the sides will tell us where we must cut.
(21)	*Teo vuri beara mosi suusuku bata maara amaa papaes vai, eara mee na taatagi bata maara a bua govara, vaa matana ae teo itao.*	When we do the next cuts along these cuts on the sides, we are also getting the two pointed ends at the bow and the stern into shape.
(22)	*Be kavara, eara repaa verete vahaa o sinivi are paa taneo tea koro a komano sinivi.*	When this is finished, we turn the canoe over again and then start cutting out the inside of the canoe.
(23)	*A maamihu kiu vai na paku vaagum ni raara.*	All these various kinds of work we do in a group.
(24)	*Beara koro vaantee a rahi voosu, o vaagum vai repaa pahin rahi voosu bari.*	When we have cut out enough for pulling (the canoe) home, this group will immediately pull it home.
(25)	*Beo sinivi suguna vaan, a too vaahito kou paku komana vai bona maa vagegeana kiu vai,*	When the canoe arrives in the village, the owner does the last pieces of work himself,
(26)	*a vaamono ae koro vagegeana bona komano sinivi.*	cutting more wood out and doing the last bits of cutting out the inside of the canoe.
(27)	*Tea taatagi bona suin no sinivi toro pakue bona vanaa*	To get the body of the canoe ready he must do it with the plane

(28) *ae toro taatagi bona komano sinivi bona koro.*

and must get the inside of the canoe into shape with the gouging tool.

(29) *Be kavara, ore paa vaobete vaavaha bono sinivi kahi bona roava ae a huan be ihuana koana bono bon pam.*

When this is finished, he puts the canoe away from the sun and the rain, while waiting for the day of lashing (the outrigger to the canoe).



(a) (b)

Figure 5: (a) *Koro* – Gouging tool, (b) *Vanaa* – Plane



Figure 6: *Koro* – Cutting out the hull